Skybrick — Publisher Pitch

Daneel Voloshen · Ukraine · mrkrob00@gmail.com · October 2026

The pitch

Castle Story raised about $700,000 on Kickstarter, found an audience of hundreds of thousands, and then went quiet. Players still ask for the game it promised. **Skybrick** is a voxel castle-builder where tiny workers dig, haul and build while you play the architect, made from day one for PC and tablets and played online, co-op against waves or head to head.

We are looking for a publishing partner and roughly **$24–50K** to take it from a working prototype to a release on Steam and Google Play in 12 months.

Players asked for this game. Twice.

Demand is proven. In 2012 Castle Story asked Kickstarter for $80,000, hit the goal in about five hours and closed at roughly $702,000 from 27,060 backers (Wikipedia, CMF-FMC). On Steam it has an estimated 200,000–500,000 owners and about 6,500 positive against 3,600 negative reviews (SteamSpy).

The gap is just as clear. In a read of 40 English Steam reviews (source), the same complaints repeat:

- the game was never finished and updates stopped;
- performance and pathfinding forced a cap on the number of units;
- the pace is slow, with no way to speed time up;
- built blocks cannot be demolished;
- workers waste effort and need constant micromanagement.

Players love the idea, the charming workers and the building. They want it finished and playable. This is a sample, not a statistical study.

The mobile seat looks empty. To our knowledge Castle Story has no mobile version, and the closest games in the genre, such as Stonehearth, Going Medieval and Gnomoria, are desktop only (AlternativeTo). We found no mobile game that combines voxel building, colony management and strategy.

You draw the plan. Your crew builds it, brick by brick.

You never control a single worker. You mark ground to dig, forests to fell and stone to quarry, then draw a blueprint for a keep, a bridge or a tower from a catalogue of voxel blocks. Your little workers decide who fetches what, carry every block at its real size and put the castle together while you plan the next wall.

The ground is yours to reshape: dig a moat, tunnel under a cliff, quarry an island down to bedrock. Enemy waves will test what you built (that part is the next milestone), and the loop is simple to read on a tablet: gather, plan, build, defend.

One game, two screens

Skybrick ships on Steam (Windows, Linux, macOS) and on Android tablets and phones from a single codebase in Godot 4. The interface is designed for fingers first: big tap targets, a tabbed block palette, a radial menu and drag-to-paint work zones. The same controls work with a mouse, and PC and tablet players are planned to share the same online match.

The look is a soft, stylised voxel world with a day and night cycle, chosen to stay light on mobile GPUs. Our target is smooth 60 FPS play on a mid-range tablet.

Built to avoid the genre's usual trap

The genre's biggest complaints are unit caps, bad pathfinding and slow, fiddly play, so we design against them from the start rather than patching later.

- **Tested logic.** Worker behaviour, building, resource flow, navigation and masonry already have automated test suites that run headless from the command line.
- **Crowd-friendly movement.** Workers walk on a custom navigation grid instead of heavy per-unit physics, so the unit limit is set by measurement, not by a hard cap.
- **The fixes players ask for.** Time speed-up and demolition of built blocks are planned for the first milestone.
- **Real-device QA.** The budget includes testing on a range of Android devices.

Where we are today

A working prototype in Godot 4, with the foundations of the loop in place:

- destructible voxel ground and quarrying with preview and depth control;
- workers that find jobs, carry resources and build from blueprints;

- stockpiles, logging and plank production, and a catalogue of 41 stone blocks with their own models and icons;
- a touch-ready interface with a block palette, task ribbon and radial menu;
- a day and night cycle and a soft cartoon look.

Still to build: enemies and combat, a round goal and ending, walking on stairs and slopes, wooden blocks, time speed-up and demolition, sound and menus, and online multiplayer. That is what the funding is for.

12 months, about $24–50K

One developer working full time, supported by freelance artists, sound, testers and a networking specialist. The range depends on how much art and audio we commission.

Item	Amount, USD	Basis
Lead developer, 12 months full time	7,200	calculation
AI coding assistant subscriptions	240–1,200	calculation
3D models and assets	4,000–10,000	estimate
Sound and music	2,000–5,000	estimate
Device QA	1,500–4,000	estimate
Networking specialist (design review, sync of units and terrain)	2,000–5,000	estimate
Online playtests across PC and Android	1,500–4,000	estimate
Lobby and relay servers, 12 months	240–1,200	estimate
Two mid-range Android test devices	300–700	estimate
Steam ($100) and Google Play ($25) fees	125	fees
Contingency	25–30%	estimate
Total	**≈ 24,000–50,000**	

Three milestones of four months each, in the order a player meets them: build and command, fight online, then more content.

Milestone	Months	What is playable at the end
1. Build, command, first enemies	1–4	Workers walk up stairs and slopes, demolish tool, pause and time speed-up. Strategy control: tap or box-select units, move, hold and attack orders, rally points, unit roles (builder, soldier, archer) and a barracks that trains them. Enemy camps and waves with their own AI, health and damage, a castle heart that ends the round if it falls. One island with a clear goal. Steam page and trailer go live.
2. Online RTS	5–8	Online matches for PC and tablet: lobby, host and join, co-op against enemy waves and head-to-head battles between two players' castles. Archers on battlements, towers and gates, menus, sound, a five-minute tutorial.
3. Content and release	9–12	Wooden blocks, bridges, weapon rack and smithing, unit upgrades. Three to five islands, more enemy types including siege, sandbox, survive and assault modes. Art and audio pass, balance, Android device QA, launch on Steam and Google Play.

What we are looking for

A publisher who will fund the three milestones one by one, and help with what a solo developer cannot do alone: the Steam page and wishlist campaign, press and streamer outreach, and Android device testing.

We can send a playable build of the prototype on request, and we are happy to talk on a call. Contact: Daneel Voloshen, solo developer, Ukraine, mrkrob00@gmail.com